When Kunti was still a young girl and was staying with her foster father Kunti-Bhoja, she was entrusted with the task of receiving guests and treating them well. Surya loved her and declared: "Neither your father, nor your mother, nor any of your elders have any right over you" (I. 99, 9-12). He also said that a woman was free to behave as she liked. He demolished the fears of Kunti by telling her that after intercourse she would regain her virginity and that the son born of the union would be very famous (III. 291, 12-16). In due time, she gave birth to the mighty Karna bedecked at birth with armor and earrings as was promised by Surya; but, due to the fear of her kinsfolk, she put Karna in a chest and floated the chest onto the Ganges. And none but an old nurse knew the secret (III. 292, 2-6).

The *Mahābhārata* narrates the legend of the adulterous intercourse of Indra—a mighty god—with the wife of the sage Gautama. The story of the illicit love between Ahalya and Indra is very old and one of the oldest Brāhamaṇas, namely, the Satapatha, addresses Indra as Ahalya's lover (III. 3, 4, 18). Once Indra disguised himself as Gautama and approached Ahalya saying, "You are in your *ṛtu* (mating season). Let me cohabit with you." Ahalya recognized Indra, but consented to his proposal out of curiosity. When she was fully satisfied, she said, "I am now fully satisfied, so please go away quickly and protect yourself, as well as me, from Gautama."

King Pratipa was approached by the river goddess Ganga for the satisfaction of her sexual desire. She occupied the right side of his lap and requested the king to satisfy her passion.

The *Mahābhārata* also refers to Śvetaketu, who begot a son by the wife of his preceptor (XII. 35, 22).

In a dialogue between Astavakra and Disa, the latter exposed her sex in the following way, "O *Brāhmana,* a woman loves the pleasure derived from senses even more than the gods like Vayu, Agni, and Varuna, because they are by nature lustful" (XIII. 19, 91-94).

A long legend is narrated about how Vipula by supernatural powers protected his preceptor's wife from the amorous advances of Indra (XIII. 40, 14).

Galava was facing a dilemma when Madhavi herself found a way out of this. She told Galava that a *brāhman* learned in the Vedas had given her a boon according to which after each delivery she would be a virgin again.

In all these episodes the virginity of the girl is restored after intercourse takes place, and one mysterious explanation or another is given as to how this happens. Thus, a virgin married her